

When Two Points Are Given

You can also find slope without a graph if you know the coordinates of two points. To find rise, subtract the y-coordinates. To find run, subtract the x-coordinates. Then write the rise over the run.

Example

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Find the equation of a line that goes through the points $(-3, 1)$ and $(-1, 3)$.

Step 1

Find the slope using the formula.

$$\frac{(3-1)}{(-1-(-3))} = 1$$

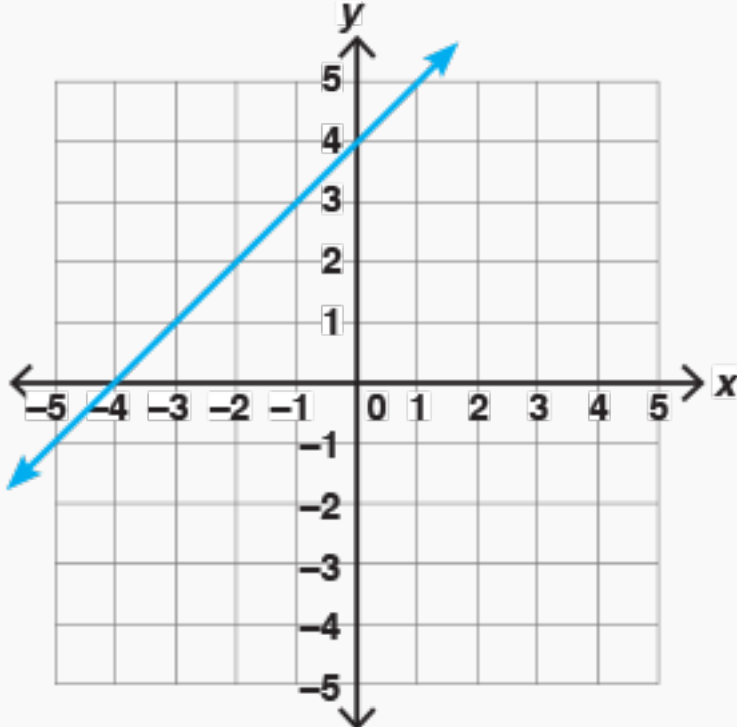
This means that the slope goes up one unit for every unit to the right.

Step 2

On a graph, plot one of the points. Starting at $(-3, 1)$, go up one unit then right one unit.

Connect the dots and continue until the line crosses the y-axis. This is the y-intercept.

In the slope-intercept form, the equation is $y = 1x + 4$.



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